

- ❖ In order to obtain lac, these insects are cultured, and the technique is called lac-culture.
- ❖ It involves proper care of host plants, regular pruning of host plants, propagation, collection and processing of lac.
- ❖ The insects live as a parasite, feeding on the sap of certain trees and shrubs.
- ❖ Mass movement of larvae from female cell to the new off-shoots of host plant, is termed as “swarming”
- ❖ The lac insects repeat its life cycle twice in a year.
- ❖ There are actually four lac crops since the lac insects behave in two ways either they develop on Kusum plants or develop on plants other than Kusum.
- ❖ The lac which grows on Non-Kusum plants is called as “Ranjeem lac,” and which grows on Kusum plant is called as “Kusumi lac.
- ❖ Lac cut from the host plant is called as “stick lac”.
- ❖ Lac can be scraped from the twigs before or after the emergence of larvae. If it is used for manufacturing before the emergence of larvae, the type of lac produced is called as “**Ari lac**” and if it is used for manufacturing purpose after swarming of larvae has occurred, the lac is said to be **Phunki lac**”.
- ❖ The scraping of lac from twig is done by knife, after which they should not be exposed to sun. The scraped lac is grinded in hard stone mills. The unnecessary materials are sorted out. In order to remove the finer particles of dirt and colour, this lac is washed repeatedly with cold water.
- ❖ Now at this stage it is called as “**Seed lac**” and is exposed to sun for drying.
- ❖ Seed lac is now subjected to the melting process.
- ❖ The melted lac is sieved through cloth and is given the final shape by molding. The final form of lac is called “**Shellac**”
- ❖ **Usage:**
 - Gramophone record
 - Floor polishes
 - Paints
 - Electrical goods
 - Sealing wax
 - Printing ink